

Canon, on the other hand, has been known to have better video recording capabilities, aided by its range of video-oriented lenses, better than Nikon's range of DSLRs. This is true in some circumstances, and shouldn't be treated as gospel truth.

But, when the top-of-the-lines are considered, the Nikon D810 is a phenomenal camera, and is quite possibly the best in its class, but you will need to tune every setting to perfection to realise its true power. The Canon 5D Mark III, that has been succeeded by the Canon 5Ds, had superior assistance, and a very powerful sensor, that has been teamed up with an equally easy interface, which makes using the camera easy in itself.

WHICH ONE SHOULD YOU PICK?

Choosing your camera should completely depend on your major areas of photography, and how adept you are at photography. For the festival-focused tourist or casual shutter-crazy camera buyers, the point-and-shoot cameras provide excellent value for the money. The mirrorless cameras are for the more evolved user looking for a lighter, smaller alternative to DSLRs, but with the power of interchangeable lenses. DSLRs are the perfect tools of photo execution, and professionals will stick to the large bodies, seeing that along with everything else, DSLRs can also pack in a mirror-up mode, making the camera function as a mirrorless unit. We advise you to hit the store, and try out various cameras by different brands, before choosing your final product.

A COMPLETE RANGE OF ACCESSORIES

Choosing the right camera is not the end of the game. Enter accessories, an equally important component of your new camera to help you support it. Breaking accessories down into sections, we have lenses, lens hoods, tripods, camera bags, memory cards, filters, battery packs, maintenance, card readers and camera straps.

To select the right lens, ensure that you know which type of lenses are compatible with the lens mount on your camera. The f-number will give you an indication of the size of the opening that allows light into the sensor and the depth of field that the lens is capable of shooting at.

DON'T FORGET TO CONSIDER

Buying a second-hand camera: The second hand DSLRs are a point to consider, too. Many professional photographers upgrade their units when new cameras are launched, so you may find a large number of second hand cameras to choose from, if you do not mind using a second-hand camera, and happen to be looking for a better camera within a restricted budget. In this segment, major things that need to be considered include warranty check, how long has it been used for, the physical condition of the camera (which is often an apt reflection of the camera's state), and a check on its internals. For second hand cameras, experiencing its state for yourself is imperative. Point it to a bright source of light, and look for any aberrations within the frame (like dust, foreign particles, etc.). Ask the dealer when the camera was obtained by him, and take a few shots in the surroundings to ensure that all elements, including the shutter, all buttons, viewfinder and the entire body is working perfectly fine. If the product has been refurbished, ensure to ask for all servicing details that were carried out on the camera. Also, ensure that all lens elements are working smoothly (autofocus motor, zoom and focus ring, lens mount). To be doubly sure, find a friend who is familiar with the camera that you intend to purchase, for a second take on it.

Online vs. Offline: While purchasing new cameras online are okay (although not recommendable, unless you are absolutely sure about which camera you want to buy), second hand cameras should never be purchased online. Imaging products may vary from what you see on the internet (refurbishing the body is easy, what matters is the condition of the sensor, mirror and all other elements inside), and as a result, you might be left thoroughly dissatisfied with your purchase, in case things do not turn out the way they were stated. There are, however, numerous photo forums, where many photographers put their used equipment up for sale. In such cases, try finding out more about the photographer himself/herself. Chances are, most photographers worth their profession will have taken extreme care of the device, and are only selling it because they've run out of space to keep more equipment at home. Even then, try meeting in person to see how the camera is working, before making a decision.

Most telephoto lenses have f-numbers of 4-5.6, which gives scope for wider depths in photographs required in landscape photography. Macro, close-up lenses like 50mm, 35mm and 60mm have f-stops of 1.4, 1.8, 2 and 2.8, creating shallow DoF.

Tripods are crucial 'stands', literally. Multiple forms of photography, like slow shutter speed, time lapse, steadicam emulation and the likes need a tripod to be teamed up with a camera. While brands like Vanguard and Manfrotto almost always guarantee excellent stability and fluidity of movement, these tripods are somewhat expensive. When picking a tripod ensure that it has individual spirit levels. Considering these factors, the Benro T-880EX is a decent tripod that you can take.

Memory cards are yet another section that you would be better off investing a little more on. A 'fast' memory card, with fast read and write speeds, is crucial in ensuring that continuous shots (during time lapse photography) or movie recording does not get interrupted. If you're serious about photography, a

filter kit is a necessity. Hoya is known for manufacturing ultraviolet, polarizer and neutral density filters, available for many different lenses. Other components of your ideal camera kit may comprise maintenance kits (Lenspen has many, ranging from singular cleaning cloths to the SensorKlear Loupe kit), extra battery packs (crucial, if you're going on a hike where electricity will be scarce), camera straps and accommodating camera bags.

Bags are yet another massive choice hub to pick from. If you own compact body cameras, you can opt for smaller ones that can be clipped on to your belt, side-sling bags for larger bodies and DSLR kits with one or two lenses, and large backpacks that come with separate slots for laptops, tripods, and small sections for every accessory. Consider the extensive range by Lowepro for different needs.

With page loads of photography advice hence offloaded, it is now time to cash in on festive deals, and pick up the camera that will suit your lifestyle the best. Happy shooting! 